



Industry News

Linux on the mainframe voted as an attractive choice

Large enterprises continue to step up their investments in Linux on the mainframe in order to deliver more value to the business, while controlling IT costs, according to a recent global study of large enterprises commissioned by CA, an independent IT management software company. The study surveyed 100 IT executives and managers at companies with at least \$2 billion in annual revenue, about their use of the Linux OS on IBM mainframes. Ninety-three per cent of the respondents projected that their use of IBM's IFL (Integrated Facility for Linux) speciality mainframe processor would increase or at least remain steady over the course of the next two years. Forty-two per cent projected that their use of the IFL would grow between 21 per cent and 40 per cent, and 10 per cent projected that it would grow more than 76 per cent.

The two main reasons cited for this increased Linux usage on the mainframe were the desire to take advantage of the computing capacity available on their mainframe's central processors and/or IFLs, and their assessment that using Linux on the mainframe would be more cost-effective than other platforms. Respondents also said they were using Linux on the mainframe to support 'green'

computing initiatives and infrastructure consolidation strategies.

Survey respondents were also asked to rate specific aspects of Linux on the mainframe as challenges or advantages. Four aspects were rated as strongly advantageous: backup, restore and disaster recovery; the ability to scale to many virtual machines; security; and availability of applications. Of these, scalability received the strongest rating overall. CA provides a set of solutions to help manage and secure z/VM and Linux environments on IBM's System z platform.

Dell working on Android pocket device

Dell is reportedly working on a pocket-sized Internet device that would run on Google's Android operating system. Fashioned after Apple's iPod Touch, Dell's unnamed gadget has been in development since last year, according to a media report. *The Wall Street Journal* said, "Two people who saw early prototypes described the device as slightly larger than Apple Inc's iPod Touch, which is similar to the iPhone but does not have cell phone capabilities. Another person who was briefed on the company's plans said Dell may begin selling the device later this year, though this source said the plan could be delayed or scrapped entirely."

Dell may use chips based on designs licensed from ARM Holdings PLC, people familiar with the company's plans told the paper. The company does not currently make any devices that use ARM-based chips.

In March this year, speaking at *Computerworld* in Tokyo, Dell CEO, Michael Dell confirmed these rumours. "It is true that we are exploring smaller-screen devices," he said. "We don't have any announcements to share today, but stay tuned as when we have new news, we will share that with you." Dell also said, "We already have agreements with many mobile carriers around netbook devices, so it wouldn't be unreasonable to expect that we would have smaller mobile Internet devices or smartphones in the future." The Texas-based company is also rumoured to be working on several Android-based smartphones that it plans to start selling later this year.



Sun stockholders approve Oracle merger agreement

Sun Microsystems has announced that at a special meeting of stockholders held on July 16, 2009, its stockholders adopted the merger agreement entered into with Oracle Corporation, under which Oracle will acquire Sun common stock for \$9.50 per share in cash. Approximately 62 per cent of Sun's stock owners voted in favour of the agreement. The transaction remains subject to regulatory approvals and other closing conditions. For more information regarding the proposed transaction, please visit www.sun.com/oracle.

MS releases GPL drivers?

Microsoft has released 20,000 lines of device driver code to the Linux community under the GPL. The code, which includes three Linux device drivers, has been submitted to the Linux kernel community for inclusion in the Linux tree. The drivers will be available to the Linux community and MS customers alike, and are supposed to enhance the performance of Linux when virtualised on Windows Server 2008 Hyper-V or Windows Server 2008 R2 Hyper-V.

Another MS patent deal

Microsoft and Melco Holdings, the parent company of Buffalo Inc and the Buffalo Group (Melco Group), have entered into an agreement that will provide Melco Group's customers with patent coverage for their use of technologies running Linux and other related open source software.